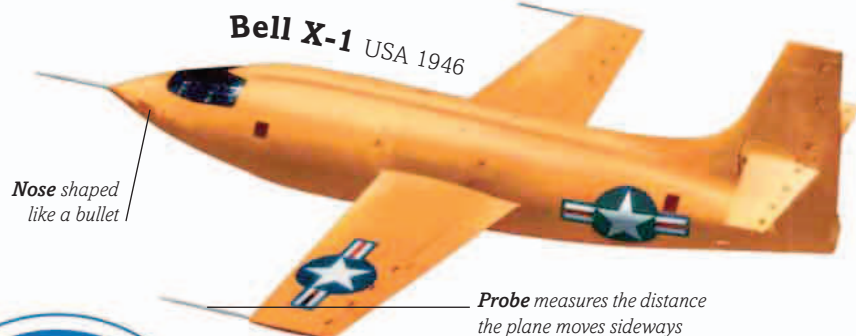
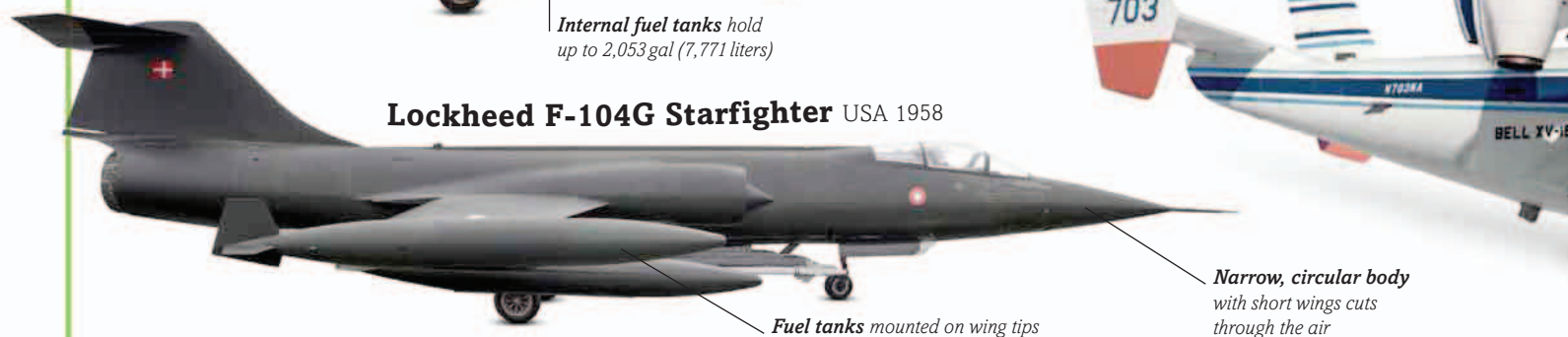




Straight up and supersonic



The Bell X-1 was nicknamed **Glamorous Glennis** after the pilot's wife.



The quest for speed led to supersonic aircraft—planes able to fly faster than the speed of sound, 767 mph (1,235 km/h) at sea level. Engineers have also created aircraft that can take off and land vertically, like a helicopter—VTOL planes.

The first supersonic aircraft was the rocket-powered **Bell X-1** piloted by American Charles “Chuck” Yeager. Improvements in jet engines saw startling increases in speeds. The **Fairey Delta 2** was the first to fly faster than 1,000 mph (1,609 km/h), the **Lockheed F-104G Starfighter**